

UK-RSE Survey 2017

The purpose of this survey is to collect information about people who develop software that is used in research. We call these people [Research Software Engineers \(RSEs\)](#), but they use many different job titles (including postdoctoral researcher and research assistant).

Why did I receive this invitation?

You have received this link because you are a member of the UK RSE Association or you were identified as someone working in an RSE role. There is currently little reliable information about the RSE community, so we have been asked to collect this information to help funders and other research organisations develop policies that will support RSEs. This questionnaire gives you the opportunity to express your views about your current job and give us information about your career path.

Please note that this research is not compulsory and even if you decide to participate you can withdraw at any moment.

How long will it take?

There is a maximum of 64 questions in this survey. It takes about 10 to 15 minutes to complete.

Who is responsible for this survey?

This study is conducted by the University of Southampton on behalf of the [Software Sustainability Institute](#) and complies with University of Southampton ethics guidelines (reference no.: ERGO/FPSE/25269). The investigators are [Simon Hettrick](#) and [Olivier Philippe](#). The survey is hosted on Limesurvey servers in Germany and respects the provisions of the [Data Protection Act](#). These records are anonymised and access is strictly protected and granted to the main researchers only. The results of the survey will be released publicly but only after they have been processed to ensure that individual respondents can not be identified. The results will be released under a [Creative Commons by attribution, non-commercial licence](#).

If you would like more information about the research or about the data collection, please contact [Olivier Philippe](#).

If you have a concern or would like to make a complaint, please contact [Simon Hettrick](#).

There are 64 questions in this survey.

Questions about you

1

In which country do you work?

*

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ United Kingdom
- ☐ Afghanistan
- ☐ Åland Islands
- ☐ Albania
- ☐ Algeria
- ☐ American Samoa
- ☐ Andorra
- ☐ Angola
- ☐ Anguilla
- ☐ Antarctica
- ☐ Antigua and Barbuda
- ☐ Argentina
- ☐ Armenia
- ☐ Aruba
- ☐ Australia
- ☐ Austria
- ☐ Azerbaijan
- ☐ Bahamas
- ☐ Bahrain
- ☐ Bangladesh
- ☐ Barbados
- ☐ Belarus
- ☐ Belgium
- ☐ Belize
- ☐ Benin
- ☐ Bermuda

- ☐ Bhutan
- ☐ Bolivia, Plurinational State of
- ☐ Bonaire, Sint Eustatius and Saba
- ☐ Bosnia and Herzegovina
- ☐ Botswana
- ☐ Bouvet Island
- ☐ Brazil
- ☐ British Indian Ocean Territory
- ☐ Brunei Darussalam
- ☐ Bulgaria
- ☐ Burkina Faso
- ☐ Burundi
- ☐ Cambodia
- ☐ Cameroon
- ☐ Canada
- ☐ Cape Verde
- ☐ Cayman Islands
- ☐ Central African Republic
- ☐ Chad
- ☐ Chile
- ☐ China
- ☐ Christmas Island
- ☐ Cocos (Keeling) Islands
- ☐ Colombia
- ☐ Comoros
- ☐ Congo
- ☐ Congo, the Democratic Republic of the
- ☐ Cook Islands
- ☐ Costa Rica
- ☐ Côte d'Ivoire
- ☐ Croatia
- ☐ Cuba

- ☐ Curaçao
- ☐ Cyprus
- ☐ Czech Republic
- ☐ Denmark
- ☐ Djibouti
- ☐ Dominica
- ☐ Dominican Republic
- ☐ Ecuador
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ El Salvador
- ☐ Equatorial Guinea
- ☐ Eritrea
- ☐ Estonia
- ☐ Ethiopia
- ☐ Falkland Islands (Malvinas)
- ☐ Faroe Islands
- ☐ Fiji
- ☐ Finland
- ☐ France
- ☐ French Guiana
- ☐ French Polynesia
- ☐ French Southern Territories
- ☐ Gabon
- ☐ Gambia
- ☐ Georgia
- ☐ Germany
- ☐ Ghana
- ☐ Gibraltar
- ☐ Greece
- ☐ Greenland
- ☐ Grenada
- ☐ Guadeloupe

- ☐ Guam
- ☐ Guatemala
- ☐ Guernsey
- ☐ Guinea
- ☐ Guinea-Bissau
- ☐ Guyana
- ☐ Haiti
- ☐ Heard Island and McDonald Islands
- ☐ Holy See (Vatican City State)
- ☐ Honduras
- ☐ Hong Kong
- ☐ Hungary
- ☐ Iceland
- ☐ India
- ☐ Indonesia
- ☐ Iran, Islamic Republic of
- ☐ Iraq
- ☐ Ireland
- ☐ Isle of Man
- ☐ Israel
- ☐ Italy
- ☐ Jamaica
- ☐ Japan
- ☐ Jersey
- ☐ Jordan
- ☐ Kazakhstan
- ☐ Kenya
- ☐ Kiribati
- ☐ Korea, Democratic People's Republic of
- ☐ Korea, Republic of
- ☐ Kuwait
- ☐ Kyrgyzstan

- ☐ Lao People's Democratic Republic
- ☐ Latvia
- ☐ Lebanon
- ☐ Lesotho
- ☐ Liberia
- ☐ Libya
- ☐ Liechtenstein
- ☐ Lithuania
- ☐ Luxembourg
- ☐ Macao
- ☐ Macedonia, the Former Yugoslav Republic of
- ☐ Madagascar
- ☐ Malawi
- ☐ Malaysia
- ☐ Maldives
- ☐ Mali
- ☐ Malta
- ☐ Marshall Islands
- ☐ Martinique
- ☐ Mauritania
- ☐ Mauritius
- ☐ Mayotte
- ☐ Mexico
- ☐ Micronesia, Federated States of
- ☐ Moldova, Republic of
- ☐ Monaco
- ☐ Mongolia
- ☐ Montenegro
- ☐ Montserrat
- ☐ Morocco
- ☐ Mozambique
- ☐ Myanmar

- ☐ Namibia
- ☐ Nauru
- ☐ Nepal
- ☐ Netherlands
- ☐ New Caledonia
- ☐ New Zealand
- ☐ Nicaragua
- ☐ Niger
- ☐ Nigeria
- ☐ Niue
- ☐ Norfolk Island
- ☐ Northern Mariana Islands
- ☐ Norway
- ☐ Oman
- ☐ Pakistan
- ☐ Palau
- ☐ Palestine, State of
- ☐ Panama
- ☐ Papua New Guinea
- ☐ Paraguay
- ☐ Peru
- ☐ Philippines
- ☐ Pitcairn
- ☐ Poland
- ☐ Portugal
- ☐ Puerto Rico
- ☐ Qatar
- ☐ Réunion
- ☐ Romania
- ☐ Russian Federation
- ☐ Rwanda
- ☐ Saint Barthélemy

- ☐ Saint Helena, Ascension and Tristan da Cunha
- ☐ Saint Kitts and Nevis
- ☐ Saint Lucia
- ☐ Saint Martin (French part)
- ☐ Saint Pierre and Miquelon
- ☐ Saint Vincent and the Grenadines
- ☐ Samoa
- ☐ San Marino
- ☐ Sao Tome and Principe
- ☐ Saudi Arabia
- ☐ Senegal
- ☐ Serbia
- ☐ Seychelles
- ☐ Sierra Leone
- ☐ Singapore
- ☐ Sint Maarten (Dutch part)
- ☐ Slovakia
- ☐ Slovenia
- ☐ Solomon Islands
- ☐ Somalia
- ☐ South Africa
- ☐ South Georgia and the South Sandwich Islands
- ☐ South Sudan
- ☐ Spain
- ☐ Sri Lanka
- ☐ Sudan
- ☐ Suriname
- ☐ Svalbard and Jan Mayen
- ☐ Swaziland
- ☐ Sweden
- ☐ Switzerland
- ☐ Syrian Arab Republic

- ☐ Taiwan, Province of China
- ☐ Tajikistan
- ☐ Tanzania, United Republic of
- ☐ Thailand
- ☐ Timor-Leste
- ☐ Togo
- ☐ Tokelau
- ☐ Tonga
- ☐ Trinidad and Tobago
- ☐ Tunisia
- ☐ Turkey
- ☐ Turkmenistan
- ☐ Turks and Caicos Islands
- ☐ Tuvalu
- ☐ Uganda
- ☐ Ukraine
- ☐ United Arab Emirates
- ☐ United Kingdom
- ☐ United States
- ☐ United States Minor Outlying Islands
- ☐ Uruguay
- ☐ Uzbekistan
- ☐ Vanuatu
- ☐ Venezuela, Bolivarian Republic of
- ☐ Viet Nam
- ☐ Virgin Islands, British
- ☐ Virgin Islands, U.S.
- ☐ Wallis and Futuna
- ☐ Western Sahara
- ☐ Yemen
- ☐ Zambia
- ☐ Zimbabwe

2

What is the highest qualification you have obtained?

*

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ GSCEs, Standard Grade, Scottish National 3, 4 or 5, or equivalent
- ☐ Further Education (NVQ A-Level, etc.)
- ☐ Undergraduate degree
- ☐ Master degree
- ☐ Doctorate
- ☐ None

3

In which subject is your highest academic qualification? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Accounting & Finance
- ☐ Aeronautical & Manufacturing Engineering
- ☐ Agriculture & Forestry
- ☐ American Studies
- ☐ Anatomy & Physiology
- ☐ Anthropology
- ☐ Architecture
- ☐ Art & Design
- ☐ Biological Sciences
- ☐ Business & Management Studies
- ☐ Chemical Engineering
- ☐ Chemistry
- ☐ Civil Engineering
- ☐ Classics & Ancient History
- ☐ Communication & Media Studies
- ☐ Complementary Medicine
- ☐ Computer Science
- ☐ Counselling
- ☐ Criminology
- ☐ Dentistry
- ☐ East & South Asian Studies
- ☐ Economics
- ☐ Education
- ☐ Electrical & Electronic Engineering
- ☐ English
- ☐ Fashion
- ☐ Food Science

- ☐ French
- ☐ Geography & Environmental Sciences
- ☐ Geology
- ☐ General Engineering
- ☐ German
- ☐ History
- ☐ History of Art, Architecture & Design
- ☐ Hospitality, Leisure, Recreation & Tourism
- ☐ Iberian Languages/Hispanic Studies
- ☐ Land & Property Management
- ☐ Law
- ☐ Librarianship & Information Management
- ☐ Linguistics
- ☐ Marketing
- ☐ Materials Technology
- ☐ Mathematics
- ☐ Mechanical Engineering
- ☐ Medicine
- ☐ Middle Eastern and African Studies
- ☐ Music
- ☐ Nursing
- ☐ Ophthalmics
- ☐ Pharmacology & Pharmacy
- ☐ Philosophy
- ☐ Physics and Astronomy
- ☐ Physiotherapy
- ☐ Politics
- ☐ Psychology
- ☐ Robotics
- ☐ Russian & East European Languages
- ☐ Social Policy
- ☐ Social Work

- ☐ Sociology
- ☐ Sports Science
- ☐ Theology & Religious Studies
- ☐ Town & Country Planning and Landscape Design
- ☐ Veterinary Medicine
- ☐ Youth Work
- ☐ Other

4 Enter your academic subject

Please write your answer here:

5 Do you hold any professional qualifications?

Please write your answer here:

If yes, please enter them separated by commas.

6 Do you write code as part of your job? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

7 Who uses the code that you write? *

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

0 - Mostly me	1	2	3	4	5 - Mostly other people
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

8

Do you consider yourself a professional software developer?

*

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

9 How many years of software development experience do you have? *

Please write your answer here:

10 In an average month, how much time do you spend on: *

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

	1 (None at all)	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10 (All my time)
Software development	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Research	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
People management	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Project management	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Teaching	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Other activities	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Please rate your answer between 1 and 10 with 1 representing no time spent on the task and 10 representing all your time spent on the task.

Your current employment

11 What type of organisation do you work for? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ University - within an academic group
- ☐ University - within an IT service
- ☐ University - within an HPC group
- ☐ Private company
- ☐ Government
- ☐ NGO
- ☐ National laboratory
- ☐ Other

12 Which university?

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ University of Aberdeen
- ☐ Abertay University
- ☐ Aberystwyth University
- ☐ Anglia Ruskin University, Cambridge
- ☐ The Arts University Bournemouth
- ☐ University of the Arts London
- ☐ Aston University, Birmingham
- ☐ Bangor University
- ☐ University of Bath
- ☐ Bath Spa University
- ☐ University of Bedfordshire, Luton and Bedford
- ☐ Birkbeck, University of London
- ☐ University of Birmingham
- ☐ Birmingham City University
- ☐ University College Birmingham
- ☐ Bishop Grosseteste University
- ☐ University Centre at Blackburn College, Blackburn
- ☐ University of Bolton
- ☐ Bournemouth University
- ☐ BPP University
- ☐ University of Bradford
- ☐ University of Brighton
- ☐ University of Bristol
- ☐ Brunel University, Uxbridge and London
- ☐ University of Buckingham
- ☐ Buckinghamshire New University, High Wycombe
- ☐ University of Cambridge
- ☐ Institute of Cancer Research

- ☐ Canterbury Christ Church University, Canterbury, Thanet, Tunbridge Wells and Chatham
- ☐ Cardiff University
- ☐ Cardiff Metropolitan University (UWIC)
- ☐ University of Central Lancashire, Preston and Burnley
- ☐ University of Chester, Chester and Warrington
- ☐ University of Chichester
- ☐ City University London
- ☐ Courtauld Institute of Art
- ☐ Coventry University
- ☐ Cranfield University, Cranfield, and Shrivenham
- ☐ University for the Creative Arts, Canterbury, Epsom, Farnham, Maidstone and Rochester
- ☐ University of Cumbria, Carlisle (main campus), London, Penrith and Ambleside
- ☐ De Montfort University, Leicester
- ☐ University of Derby
- ☐ University of Dundee
- ☐ Durham University, Durham and Stockton-on-Tees (Queen's Campus)
- ☐ University of East Anglia, Norwich
- ☐ University of East London
- ☐ Edge Hill University, Ormskirk, Lancashire
- ☐ University of Edinburgh
- ☐ Edinburgh Napier University
- ☐ University of Essex, Colchester and Southend-on-Sea
- ☐ University of Exeter
- ☐ Falmouth University
- ☐ University of Glasgow
- ☐ Glasgow Caledonian University
- ☐ University of Gloucestershire, Cheltenham, Gloucester and London
- ☐ Goldsmiths, University of London
- ☐ University of Greenwich
- ☐ Glyndŵr University, Wrexham
- ☐ Harper Adams University, Newport, Shropshire
- ☐ Heriot-Watt University, Edinburgh and Galashiels

- ☐ University of Hertfordshire, Hatfield
- ☐ Heythrop College
- ☐ University of the Highlands & Islands, Inverness (main campus), Elgin, Perth & across north and western Scotland
- ☐ University of Huddersfield, Huddersfield & Barnsley
- ☐ University of Hull, Hull and Scarborough
- ☐ Imperial College London
- ☐ Keele University, Staffordshire
- ☐ University of Kent, Canterbury and Medway
- ☐ King's College London
- ☐ Kingston University
- ☐ Lancaster University
- ☐ University of Law
- ☐ University of Leeds
- ☐ Leeds Beckett University
- ☐ Leeds Trinity University
- ☐ University of Leicester
- ☐ University of Lincoln, Lincoln, Hull, Riseholme and Holbeach
- ☐ University of Liverpool
- ☐ Liverpool Hope University
- ☐ Liverpool John Moores University
- ☐ University College London (UCL)
- ☐ London Business School
- ☐ London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE)
- ☐ London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine
- ☐ University of London Institute in Paris
- ☐ University of London International Programmes (Distance Learning)
- ☐ London Metropolitan University
- ☐ London South Bank University
- ☐ Loughborough University
- ☐ University of Manchester
- ☐ Manchester Metropolitan University

- ☐ University Marine Biological Station, Millport
- ☐ Middlesex University, London
- ☐ Newcastle University
- ☐ Newman University, Birmingham
- ☐ University of Northampton
- ☐ Northumbria University, Newcastle upon Tyne
- ☐ Norwich University of the Arts
- ☐ University of Nottingham
- ☐ Nottingham Trent University
- ☐ The Open University, Milton Keynes
- ☐ University of Oxford
- ☐ Oxford Brookes University
- ☐ University of Plymouth
- ☐ University of Portsmouth
- ☐ Queen's University Belfast
- ☐ Queen Margaret University, Edinburgh
- ☐ Queen Mary, University of London
- ☐ University of Reading
- ☐ Regent's University London
- ☐ The Robert Gordon University, Aberdeen
- ☐ Roehampton University, London
- ☐ Royal Academy of Music
- ☐ Royal Agricultural University, Cirencester
- ☐ Royal Central School of Speech and Drama
- ☐ Royal College of Art, London
- ☐ Royal Holloway, University of London, Egham
- ☐ Royal Veterinary College
- ☐ University of St Andrews
- ☐ St George's, University of London
- ☐ University of St Mark & St John, Plymouth
- ☐ St Mary's University, Twickenham
- ☐ University of Salford

- ☐ School of Advanced Study
- ☐ School of Oriental and African Studies (SOAS)
- ☐ University of Sheffield
- ☐ Sheffield Hallam University
- ☐ University of Southampton
- ☐ Southampton Solent University
- ☐ University of South Wales
- ☐ Staffordshire University, Stoke-on-Trent, Stafford and Lichfield
- ☐ University of Stirling, Bridge of Allan
- ☐ University of Strathclyde
- ☐ University of Strathclyde, Glasgow
- ☐ University of Sunderland
- ☐ University of Surrey, Guildford
- ☐ University of Sussex, Falmer and Brighton
- ☐ Swansea University
- ☐ Teesside University, Middlesbrough and Darlington
- ☐ Ulster University, Coleraine, Jordanstown, Magee and Belfast
- ☐ University of Wales, Trinity Saint David
- ☐ University of Warwick, Coventry
- ☐ University of West London, Ealing and Brentford
- ☐ University of Westminster, London
- ☐ University of the West of England, Bristol
- ☐ University of the West of Scotland, Paisley, Hamilton, Ayr & Dumfries
- ☐ University of Winchester
- ☐ University of Wolverhampton
- ☐ University of Worcester
- ☐ University of York
- ☐ York St John University

Universities are listed in order of the city in which they are based (i.e. the University of Aberdeen is first, and York St. John University is last).

13 Please enter the university

Please write your answer here:

14

Which organisation do you work for?

Please write your answer here:

15 What is your official job title

Please write your answer here:

(i.e. the job title on your contract of employment)

16 Are you known in your group by a different job title? If so, please enter the job title you use

Please write your answer here:

(e.g. the job title on your group website or business cards)

17

Do you work full time or part time?

*

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Full Time

☐ Part-time

18

What type of contract are you employed on?

*

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Permanent -- funded by University core funding

☐ Permanent -- as long as funding is available

☐ Fixed term

☐ Agency staff

☐ Freelancer consultant contractor

☐ Zero hours contract

☐ Other/Not listed

19

What is the duration of your current contract in months?

*

Please write your answer here:

20

When did you start your contract

*

Please enter a date:

21 In which disciplines do you work (select as many as apply)? *

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ Accounting & Finance
- ☐ Aeronautical & Manufacturing Engineering
- ☐ Agriculture & Forestry
- ☐ American Studies
- ☐ Anatomy & Physiology
- ☐ Anthropology
- ☐ Architecture
- ☐ Art & Design
- ☐ Biological Sciences
- ☐ Business & Management Studies
- ☐ Chemical Engineering
- ☐ Chemistry
- ☐ Civil Engineering
- ☐ Classics & Ancient History
- ☐ Communication & Media Studies
- ☐ Complementary Medicine
- ☐ Computer Science
- ☐ Counselling
- ☐ Criminology
- ☐ Dentistry
- ☐ East & South Asian Studies
- ☐ Economics
- ☐ Education
- ☐ Electrical & Electronic Engineering
- ☐ English
- ☐ Fashion
- ☐ Food Science
- ☐ French
- ☐ Geography & Environmental Sciences
- ☐ Geology
- ☐ General Engineering

- ☐ German
- ☐ History
- ☐ History of Art, Architecture & Design
- ☐ Hospitality, Leisure, Recreation & Tourism
- ☐ Iberian Languages/Hispanic Studies
- ☐ Land & Property Management
- ☐ Law
- ☐ Librarianship & Information Management
- ☐ Linguistics
- ☐ Marketing
- ☐ Materials Technology
- ☐ Mathematics
- ☐ Mechanical Engineering
- ☐ Medicine
- ☐ Middle Eastern and African Studies
- ☐ Music
- ☐ Nursing
- ☐ Ophthalmics
- ☐ Pharmacology & Pharmacy
- ☐ Philosophy
- ☐ Physics and Astronomy
- ☐ Physiotherapy
- ☐ Politics
- ☐ Psychology
- ☐ Robotics
- ☐ Russian & East European Languages
- ☐ Social Policy
- ☐ Social Work
- ☐ Sociology
- ☐ Sports Science
- ☐ Theology & Religious Studies
- ☐ Town & Country Planning and Landscape Design
- ☐ Veterinary Medicine
- ☐ Youth Work
- ☐ Other

Your employment history

22 Where was your previous job based? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ This is my first job
- ☐ University
- ☐ Private company
- ☐ Government
- ☐ NGO
- ☐ National laboratory
- ☐ Other

23 Rank the following factors dependent on how strongly they influenced your decision to accept your current position

Please number each box in order of preference from 1 to 9

Freedom to choose own working practices

Desire to advance research

The salary

Opportunity to develop software

Flexible working hours

Desire to work in a research environment

Opportunity for career advancement

Ability to work across disciplines

I want to learn new skills

Your working practices

24

Do you always work with the same researcher(s), or do you regularly change the researcher(s) you work with?

*

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐

Same researcher(s)

☐

Regularly change researcher(s)

25 Do you work for a Research Software Group? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ N/A

26

Has your software contributed to research that has been published in a journal or at a conference?

*

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ I don't know

27 In general, when your software contributes to a paper, are you acknowledged in that paper? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ I don't know

28 Are you generally named as the main author of the paper? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ I don't know

29 Are you generally named as a co-author of the paper? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ I don't know

30 Are you generally acknowledged in the main text of the paper? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ I don't know

31 Have you ever presented your software work at a conference or workshop? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

32 Which conferences or workshops?

Please write your answer here:

Name as many as you wish, and please separate multiple entries with a comma

33 How many software projects are you currently involved with?

Please write your answer here:

34

What is the bus factor of your most important software project?

*

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5+

Your "most important software project" is the work-related project that you believe to have had the greatest impact on the research community.

The "bus factor" designates the minimal number of developers that have to be hit by a bus (or quit) before a project is incapacitated.

35

Is there a technical handover plan for your most important software project?

*

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Your "most important software project" is the work-related project that you believe to have had the greatest impact on the research community.

A "technical handover plan" describes a software project in sufficient detail to bring new developers up to speed on how to work with the software.

36 In general, what sort of testing do you conduct on your software? (check all that apply) *

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ No formal testing
- ☐ Developers conduct testing
- ☐ Test engineers conduct testing
- ☐ Users conduct testing

37

Have you ever released your software under an open-source licence?

*

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

38 How often do you release the software projects you've worked on under an open-source licence?

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

- | Never | Sometimes | Often | Very Often | Always |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

39 Have you ever used a Digital Object Identifier (DOI) to identify your software? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

40

How often do you associate your software with a Digital Object Identifier (DOI)?

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

Never	Sometimes	Often	Very Often	Always
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

41 Have you ever trained researchers in computational techniques? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

42 On average, how many times a year do you take part in providing training?

Please write your answer here:

43 What training programs are you involved with (comma separated list)?

Please write your answer here:

(For example, Software Carpentry, local university training, etc.)

44 Do you know the source of the funding used to support you and your current, largest project? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Don't want to answer

45 Which of the following sources are used to pay for your effort as an RSE/ equivalent?

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ I volunteer my time
- ☐ Donation button
- ☐ Crowdfunding (one-time)
- ☐ Crowdfunding (recurring)
- ☐ Books & merchandise
- ☐ Advertising & sponsorships
- ☐ Industry support
- ☐ Consulting & services
- ☐ Grants
- ☐ SaaS
- ☐ Membership
- ☐ Dual license
- ☐ Open core
- ☐ Foundations & consortiums
- ☐ Venture capital
- ☐ Trademark licensing & franchising

Answers (as many as apply)

46 Which of the following sources are used to fund your current, largest project?

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ Volunteers
- ☐ Donation button
- ☐ Crowdfunding (one-time)
- ☐ Crowdfunding (recurring)
- ☐ Books & merchandise
- ☐ Advertising & sponsorships
- ☐ Industry support
- ☐ Consulting & services
- ☐ Grants
- ☐ SaaS
- ☐ Membership
- ☐ Dual license
- ☐ Open core
- ☐ Foundations & consortiums
- ☐ Venture capital
- ☐ Trademark licensing & franchising

Answers (as many as apply)

47 Which of the following sources were used to fund your current, largest project three years ago?

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ My previous project is less than 3 years old
- ☐ Volunteers
- ☐ Donation button
- ☐ Crowdfunding (one-time)
- ☐ Crowdfunding (recurring)
- ☐ Books & merchandise
- ☐ Advertising & sponsorships
- ☐ Industry support
- ☐ Consulting & services
- ☐ Grants
- ☐ SaaS
- ☐ Membership
- ☐ Dual license
- ☐ Open core
- ☐ Foundations & consortiums
- ☐ Venture capital
- ☐ Trademark licensing & franchising

Answers (as many as apply)

Your perception of your current position

This section asks questions about your feelings toward your current job. Please note that there are no good or bad answers. Please try to answer as more honestly as possible.

48 Please rate the following propositions. There are no right or wrong answers

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
I find real enjoyment in my job	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I can think of a number of organisations that would probably offer me a job	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am satisfied with the recognition I receive from my supervisor/line manager for doing my job	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most days I am enthusiastic about my job	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am satisfied with a word of thanks from my supervisor/line manager	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

49 Please rate the following propositions. There are no right or wrong answers

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

	Never	Sometimes	Often	Very Often	Always
Do you receive sufficient information on the results of your work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
How often do you consider leaving your job?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Do you get the opportunity to check on how well you are doing your work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Do you have access to sufficient data and information to do your work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
How often do you dream about getting another job that will better suit your needs?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Do your colleagues inform you about how well you are doing your work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

50 Please rate the following propositions. There are no right or wrong answers

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
My experience is in demand on the labour market	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My current job satisfies my personal needs	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am satisfied with the compliments from my supervisor/line manager concerning my work	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I feel satisfied with my job	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
It would not be very difficult for me to get an equivalent job in a different organisation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

51 Please rate the following propositions. There are no right or wrong answers

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

	Never	Sometimes	Often	Very Often	Always
Does your work provide you with direct feedback on how well you are doing?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
How often do you look forward to another day at work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Do you receive sufficient information on the purpose of your work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
How often do you feel frustrated when not given the opportunity to achieve your personal work-related goals?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Does your supervisor/line manager inform you about how well you are doing your work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

52 Please rate the following propositions. There are no right or wrong answers

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
I like my job more than average	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I would accept another job at the same compensation level if I was offered it	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am satisfied with my supervisor/line manager's confidence in me	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Given my qualifications and experience, getting a new job would not be very hard at all	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am satisfied with the encouragement from my supervisor/line manager while doing my job	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

53 In general, how satisfied are you with:

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

	0 - Not at all satisfied	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10 - Completely satisfied
Your current position	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Your career	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Demographic questions

This section helps us learn more about the people within the RSE community. None of the questions are mandatory, but they provide us with very useful information about the community in general.

54 Please select your gender

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Female
- ☐ Male
- ☐ Other
- ☐ Do not wish to declare

55 Please select your age

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ 18 to 24 years
- ☐ 25 to 34 years
- ☐ 35 to 44 years
- ☐ 45 to 54 years
- ☐ 55 to 64 years
- ☐ 65 or older
- ☐ Do not wish to declare

56 How would you describe your ethnic origin? This refers to people who share the same cultural background and identity, not country of birth or nationality.

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ White: English / Welsh / Scottish / Northern Irish / British
- ☐ White: Irish
- ☐ White: Gypsy or Irish Traveller
- ☐ White: Any other White background
- ☐ Mixed / Multiple Ethnic groups: White and Black Caribbean
- ☐ Mixed / Multiple Ethnic groups: White and Black African
- ☐ Mixed / Multiple Ethnic groups: White and Asian
- ☐ Mixed / Multiple Ethnic groups: Any other Mixed / Multiple ethnic background,
- ☐ Asian / Asian British: Indian
- ☐ Asian / Asian British: Pakistani
- ☐ Asian / Asian British: Bangladeshi
- ☐ Asian / Asian British: Chinese
- ☐ Asian / Asian British: Any other Asian background
- ☐ Black / African / Caribbean / Black British: African
- ☐ Black / African / Caribbean / Black British: Caribbean
- ☐ Black / African / Caribbean / Black British: Any other Black / African / Caribbean background
- ☐ Other Ethnic group: Arab
- ☐ Other Ethnic group: Any other ethnic group
- ☐ Do not wish to declare

Choose one option that best describes your ethnic group or background

57 Do you have a condition that is defined as a disability by the Equality Act 2010*

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Do not wish to answer

58 Please select the range of your salary

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ < £18,031
- ☐ ≥ £18,031 and < £24,057
- ☐ ≥ £24,057 and < £32,277
- ☐ ≥ £32,277 and < £43,325
- ☐ ≥ £43,325 and < £58,172
- ☐ ≥ £58,172
- ☐ Do not wish to declare

Final questions

Finally, we'd like some information about the skills you possess and tools you use. None of these questions are mandatory.

59 What Operating System do you prefer to use at work?

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ GNU/Linux
- ☐ OS X
- ☐ Windows
- ☐ Other

60 What programming languages do you use at work? (Select as many as apply)

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ Assembly
- ☐ C
- ☐ C#
- ☐ C++
- ☐ Clojure
- ☐ CoffeeScript
- ☐ Common Lisp
- ☐ CUDA
- ☐ Dart
- ☐ Elixir
- ☐ Erlang
- ☐ F#
- ☐ FORTRAN
- ☐ Go
- ☐ Groovy
- ☐ Hack
- ☐ Haskell
- ☐ Java
- ☐ JavaScript
- ☐ Julia
- ☐ Lua
- ☐ Markup languages (HTML, markdown,...)
- ☐ Matlab
- ☐ Objective-C
- ☐ Perl
- ☐ PHP
- ☐ Python
- ☐ R
- ☐ Ruby
- ☐ Rust
- ☐ Scala

- ☐ Smalltalk
- ☐ SQL
- ☐ Swift
- ☐ Unix Shell Scripting
- ☐ TypeScript
- ☐ VB.NET
- ☐ VBA
- ☐ Visual Basic

61 Are you a member of the UK RSE Association? (Members are people who have signed up to the UK RSE mailing list at www.rse.ac.uk)

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

62 How do you meet other RSEs?

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ UK RSE Association
- ☐ Local RSE group/network
- ☐ N/A

63 What skills would you like to acquire or improve to help your work as a Research Software Engineer? The skills can be technical and non-technical.

Please write your answer(s) here:

Skill 1

Skill 2

Skill 3

64 How did you learn the skills you need to become an RSE?

Please write your answer here:

Thank you for your participation. If you are interested in the outcomes of this survey, please keep an eye on the [Software Sustainability Institute's website](#). You can also get updates by joining the [UK RSE Association](#).

29-06-2017 – 15:07

Submit your survey.

Thank you for completing this survey.